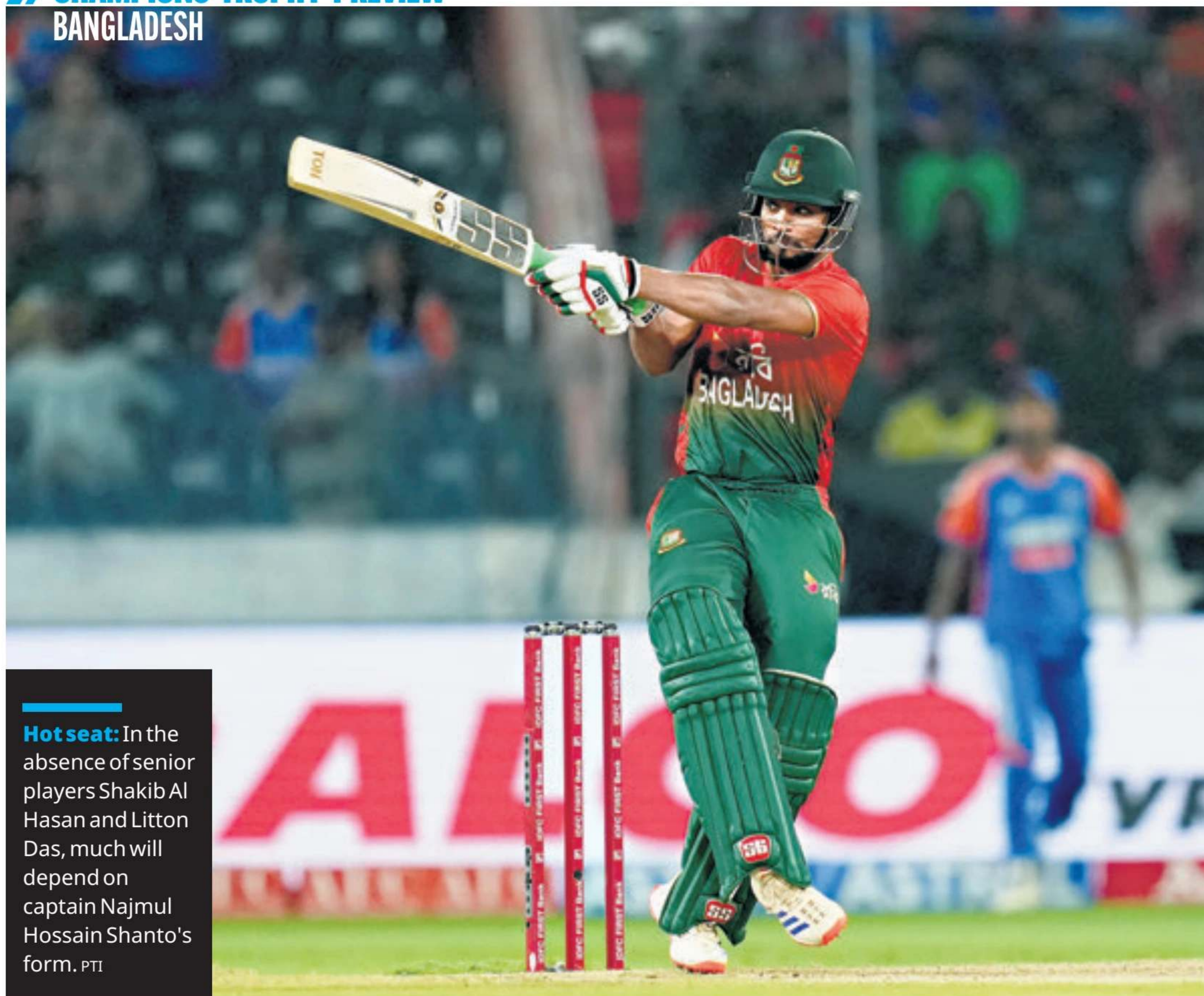




Hot seat: In the absence of senior players Shakib Al Hasan and Litton Das, much will depend on captain Najmul Hossain Shanto's form. PTI

Battle of grit over firepower

Bangladesh seems like a team built to score 300 but destined to concede 320, a side of accumulators **lacking the firepower** to tip the equation in their favour.

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Bangladesh's squad for the ICC Champions Trophy 2025 can best be described as a team of accumulators, lacking significant firepower.

Opening its campaign against a formidable India in Dubai, UAE, before travelling to Rawalpindi

for its remaining Group A fixtures against New Zealand and host Pakistan, Bangladesh appears to be a side built to score 300 but concede 320 — an unfavourable equation. The omission of Shakib Al Hasan and the retirement of Tamim Iqbal mark a significant transition, as this will be the first ICC tournament since 2007

that Bangladesh will contest without these two stalwarts.

The selectors have named Soumya Sarkar and Tanzid Hasan as the team's openers, opting to leave out the experienced Litton Das due to his prolonged poor form. Explaining the decision, Bangladesh's chief selector, Gazi Ashraf Hossain,